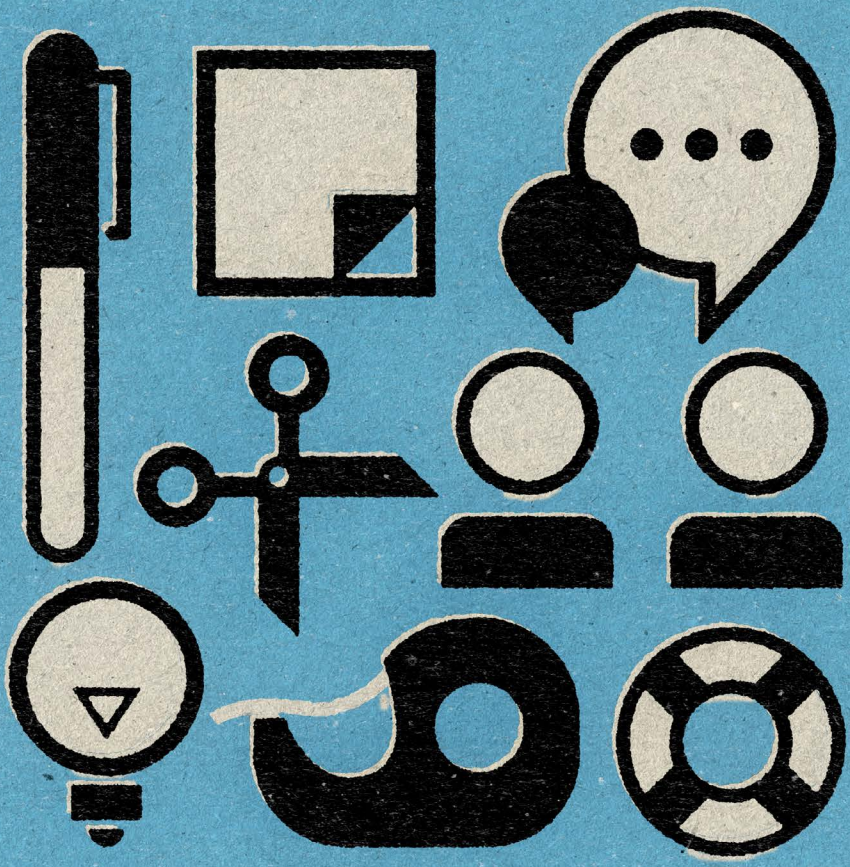
Enterprise Design Thinking
Workshop Playbook

VERSION 2.3



A guide to hosting a successful Enterprise Design Thinking Workshop in GBS

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VERSION 2.3

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❶ Is a workshop right for your engagement?

Enterprise Design Thinking Workshops are time-boxed, outcome-driven events. During workshops, teams actively collaborate to achieve a shared understanding of the problem at hand and the most logical solutions for it. It's important to understand that Enterprise Design Thinking Workshops are not about selling IBM products and services: they are about proactively solving business problems for both ourselves and our clients. Workshops help point us toward the right products, services, and innovations for overcoming user challenges. They help define what our work is and how it will get done.

It's also important to note that applying Enterprise Design Thinking to your engagement or project doesn't start and stop with a workshop. There is often design work to be done before the workshop, and there will most certainly be design work to be done after. There's no point in having a workshop if you don't have the resources in place to act on the solutions that come out of it.

Why might you hold an Enterprise Design Thinking Workshop?

- To design a solution for prospective or existing clients.
- To identify risks and plan mitigation strategies preceding a new relationship or project.
- To scope and prioritize new projects and initiatives.
- To identify and solve problems in delivery.
- To explore new ideas for continuous improvement or innovation related to existing services.

An Enterprise Design Thinking workshop can be a powerful tool, but for it to be effective, “yes” must be the answer to all of the following questions:

- Are you interested in developing new ideas, as opposed to being constrained by a solution you already have in mind?
- Are you clear about what product or process you want to improve?
- Can the issue at hand be defined in terms of users or stakeholders?
- Can you ensure the participation of those who understand both the relevant user experiences, and the underlying technologies and business domains?
- Do you have the resources, included a dedicated project manager, to move forward after the workshop?

If you can make these commitments, the following sections will guide you in your efforts. If these commitments seem far-fetched, it may be that an Enterprise Design Thinking workshop is not appropriate at this time. You might just need a good old-fashioned meeting instead.

❷ The basics: workshop structure and purpose

Who is this for?

Enterprise Design Thinking Workshops may be held with internal IBM teams, prospective clients, or existing clients. Workshops are typically proposed to members of the C-Suite, line-of-business executives, or any technical or non-technical leaders interested in infusing innovation into their employee or customer experience.

What types of workshops are there?

There are typically four types of workshops: one-day, two-day, four-day, and ad hoc.

ONE-DAY WORKSHOPS

Also called "Executive Workshops," one-day workshops provide a great introduction to Enterprise Design Thinking and can be used to achieve a number of outcomes. Typical use cases include:

- Initial collaboration around potential transformative solutions.
- Redefining current issues from an end-user point-of-view.
- Establishing an action plan for future workshops.
- Identifying risks at the beginning of a project and making a plan to mitigate them.

TWO-DAY WORKSHOPS

The most common workshop format in GBS is the two-day workshop. It is less rushed than a one-day and allows ample time to:

- Train and educate teams on adopting Enterprise Design Thinking.
- Work through current solution or process issues and stakeholder experience challenges.
- Ideate and plan for near- and long-term improvement of key stakeholder experiences.
- Develop change management plans.

FOUR-DAY WORKSHOPS

This format is best for digging deep into a project, and are often used to:

- Outline and prototype new processes and solutions.
- Re-engineer processes.
- Work through continuous improvement and process management opportunities.
- Kick off development projects.

AD-HOC SESSION

There is often a need for shorter design sessions to be worked into meetings where other discussions must take place. In these cases, there are generally a limited number of exercises that are completed in a few hours. Common outcomes for ad-hoc sessions include:

- Understanding and aligning on what you do and don't know about users and their work.
- Ideating against a known problem or pain point.
- Defining and refining Hills to guide work for the next release or planning period.
- Exploring new user experiences.
- Completing a premortem to identify risks at the beginning of a project.

Who is going to help me with my workshop?

You will be assigned a Design Lead for your workshop. This Design Lead will be your primary point of contact before and after the workshop. He/she will facilitate the workshop itself and will help you ensure the event is a success.

Depending on your workshop size and objective, you may also be assigned co-facilitators or support facilitators. The Design Lead will continue to be your primary point of contact even in this case, and will handle any coordination with co-facilitators and support facilitators.

What will we do during the workshop?

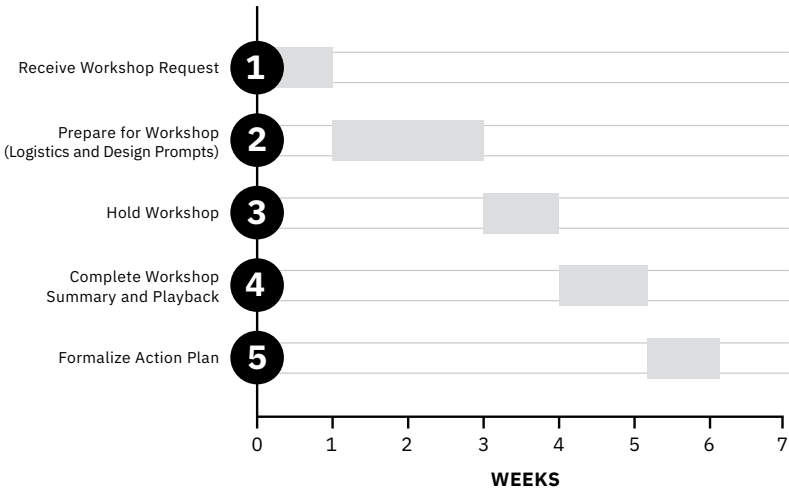
The Enterprise Design Thinking framework includes a variety of content and exercises that can be leveraged during a workshop. The Design Lead for your workshop will craft the workshop agenda based on the objective, duration, and size of your workshop. A few sample agendas are available in Appendix A for your convenience.

How much total time does it take?

You can expect the following time commitments when organizing your workshop:

- Approximately 8 hours of preparation work, including calls with your Design Lead.
- Up to 1 day of on-site workshop preparation with all IBM participants (applicable to client workshops only).
- 1-4 days for workshop.
- 1 day to recap, prioritize next steps, and complete the Workshop Playback deck.
- Ongoing execution, where applicable, to advance any initiatives agreed to during the workshop.

The typical timeline looks something like this:



Can we hold a virtual workshop?

While the idea of holding a virtual design thinking workshop is appealing for many reasons—particularly when considering travel costs — it's not a practice that we encourage or support, for a number of reasons:

- Remote collaboration is possible for small, acute tasks, but not for a workshop. There is a difference.
- Workshops are strategically designed to put people — and minds — together physically in a space where each others' expressions, body language and interactions can be seen, touched and heard.
- A lot of "silent ideation" occurs in workshops. This is lost in other formats. Silent ideation is purposely done to give everyone a voice — to allow all ideas to be heard. This does not always happen in a virtual format, unless we're using a tool like Mural.ly, and that still removes the extremely important human element.
- A captive audience is important. When remote participation is involved you cannot control captivity. You don't know when people have left for the bathroom, to get a snack or walk the dog, or if they're even listening at all.
- People tend to "hide" behind a phone/computer — you cannot hide in a workshop.

- Part of our roles as Design Leads is to catalyze communication, challenge assumptions and teach nuances in Enterprise Design Thinking; none of which can be effectively accomplished remotely or by phone since we cannot see interactions or build off participant ideas.
- Part of what makes Enterprise Design Thinking Sessions so coveted is their ability to engage teams bringing together a wide variety of thought power. The essence of “teams” is lost when people work alone in silos.
- Enterprise Design Thinking workshops are experiences in and of themselves. That experience is not only intentional, but memorable. People gain new capacities as a result of such experiences.

What will it cost me?

You will be billed an hourly rate for time spent by your Design Lead and any co-facilitators in workshop preparation, facilitation, and follow-up. You will also be responsible for reimbursing travel expenses for the Lead and all other facilitators. All engagements and subsequent accounting will be governed by a Document of Understanding (DOU) issued to you by your Design Lead. Once final travel expenses are totaled, you’ll receive a journal for the final amount.

Workshop coordinators will also need to cover the cost of workshop supplies, facility rental, and/or catering as applicable. These expenses will not be included in the DOU or go through the design team.

What will it cost the client?

For a two-day workshop, an all-inclusive fee of $50,000 is recommended. This covers facilitator time, travel expenses, supplies, catering, and the intellectual property of Enterprise Design Thinking. That amount may be discounted or even waived at the partner’s discretion, but the design team costs remain the same.

❸ How to set up a workshop

Think through your desired outcome and make sure Enterprise Design Thinking is the appropriate tool to help you get there. (See Section 2.)

Request the assignment of a Design Lead.

- Fill out the Request Form for EDT Support
- Expect to need approximately one facilitator for every 8-12 workshop participants.
- Work with your Design Lead on finalizing dates for the workshop; if you lock in a date before you have facilitators, you may find yourself without a Lead.
- Identify the person on the team who will be the primary point of contact for the Design Lead. This person will need to coordinate (or delegate) logistics such as room reservations, order supplies, and catering. This person will also work with the Design Lead on workshop prep, finalizing the agenda and developing design prompts.
- Return the signed DOU to the Design Lead with all necessary information completed.

Begin work on design prompts.

Familiarize yourself with the content in Section 5. Once a Design Lead is assigned, he/she will help you with this process.

It's important to finalize design prompts in advance in order to ensure you invite the right participants to the workshop. If no one there really understands the key user, the workshop will not be effective.

Finalize participant list.

- You need a complete participant list to ensure you have enough facilitators and adequate meeting room space.
- For client workshops, try to balance the number of IBM and client attendees.
- Try to include Sponsor Users in your workshops — people in the actual roles that are relevant to the design prompt.
- Divide the participants into breakout groups.
  - Each group will focus on a separate user or problem.
  - Groups should be made up of 4-7 cross-discipline participants.
  - Ensure there is adequate subject matter expertise in each group.
  - Include at least one Sponsor User per group. If a Sponsor User isn't available, ensure that there is at least one person in the group who is familiar at a granular level with the user or stakeholder identified in your design prompt.
  - Separate managers and reports if you can so that everyone in the group feels comfortable sharing their thoughts and ideas.
  - Mix genders and levels of seniority.

Reserve a room.

- Ideally, you want a space with room for 1.5-2x the number of participants to ensure adequate wall space for the breakout groups.
- Significant empty wall space is critical for the groups to work (we'll be hanging paper on the wall). Glass windows can also work well as wall space.
- If the room is too small, the workshop will not be a good experience.
- Bring the client to an IBM Studio space if you can. A workshop can be held in virtually any location, but there is a distinct advantage to hosting the client in these high-energy spaces.

- It is important to keep everyone in the same room the entire time, even during breakout activities, so everyone can learn and benefit from the discoveries of individual groups.
- The same room should be used each day of the workshop.
- Your room will need to be booked for a half day prior to the workshop for setup.
- The room will need a large TV or projector.
- You'll need a chair for every participant, but tables are optional.
- Some IBM facilities don't allow Post-It notes to be used on the walls; if this is the case, you need to have several rolling whiteboards and/or flipcharts for each of the breakout groups.

Order supplies.

A full list of required supplies is available in Appendix B. Note that a workshop cannot be successful without the appropriate supplies. And, yes, you're reading that right. You're going to need a whole lot of Post-It notes.

Arrange for catering.

Even if you aren't having lunch brought in, you should arrange to have coffee and refreshments in the morning and mid-afternoon. When you don't, people tend to wander away to find these things on their own, and you need everyone's participation to make the workshop a success. There is also value in the organic cross-pollination of ideas that come from the mingling that happens during breaks.

Understand post-workshop expectations.

Make sure you're set up for ongoing success after your workshop has ended. More information about post-workshop expectations is outlined in Section 6.

Invite participants.

It is absolutely critical that expectations are set appropriately before a workshop. You can download a sample welcome letter template that includes recommended pre-workshop reading and shares workshop ground rules here: Welcome Letter Template (.doc).

Workshop Checklist

- [ ] Compile preliminary participant list to establish workshop size and number of necessary Design Leads/co-facilitators
- [ ] Finalize date and location; ensure room has adequate wall space, projector/TV, and audio
- [ ] Share background material with Design Lead
- [ ] Return completed DOU to Design Lead
- [ ] Work on design prompts with Design Lead
- [ ] Validate design prompts with client
- [ ] Finalize participant list (considering prompts and likely users)
- [ ] Order supplies
- [ ] Order catering (AM snacks, lunch, PM snacks)
- [ ] Finalize composition of breakout groups
- [ ] Assist Design Lead in setting up the room once onsite

❹ Communicating with clients

We've created a deck that introduces clients to the concept of Enterprise Design Thinking and explains how a typical workshop goes. It's imperative to focus on the desired outcome of the workshop and not suggest that Enterprise Design Thinking is itself a product. Nor is it a cure-all magic bullet — it's simply a proven, effective way to encourage collaboration, bring clarity and alignment, and change perspectives to be more empathetic to your end users. Download the client deck in .key, .ppt, or .pdf.

You may also share this video which helps set expectations for a client workshop: Enterprise Design Thinking Client Video

This is a sample SOW (.doc) to customize for your specific opportunity.

If a client is interested in a more detailed look at Enterprise Design Thinking, you can direct them to the Enterprise Design Thinking website for an overview, or share the Enterprise Design Thinking Field Guide (.pdf) for more detailed information about exercises.

❺ Pre-work

DESIGN PROMPTS

With Enterprise Design Thinking, we start by identifying a specific problem to be solved. This is the single most important factor for success; if we set out to solve the wrong problem, we're not going to improve the experiences of our stakeholders and we've just wasted our time.

We can go into a workshop with some flexibility, and certainly some open questions about which specific stakeholders deserve our attention, but it's critical we don't try to use Enterprise Design Thinking in situations where its exercises and artifacts won't be of great value.

If you're trying to solve a problem that doesn't immediately suggest a stakeholder/end user whose experience or process we can map out and examine, this framework might not work for you. If you are seeking validation for a solution you've already settled on, it will be evident to all participants and diminish the value of the workshop.

It's essential that a strong design prompt be developed prior to a workshop. The design prompt is the central, guiding thought for the entire event. Think of it as an objective statement, or an area of exploration for your workshop. It doesn't have to be perfect — the user and pain points may shift as we collaborate — but it's an essential first step.

The design prompt follows either of these structures:

How might we...
(what problem needs solving or improvement?)

for...
(which person is most affected by this?)

EXAMPLE: *How might we* ***provide a more personalized experience*** *for a* ***job applicant*** *based upon their preferred communication style?*

Design a better way for...
(which person is most affected?)

to...
(what does this person need to be able to do?)

EXAMPLE: *Design a better way for a* ***financial security analyst*** *to* ***immediately and effectively prioritize the most vital imminent threats.***

More good examples:

How might we improve the workspace of an app developer to make them more confident and productive?

Design a better way for a commercial tenant to have their maintenance issue resolved without ever having to talk to another person.

How might we make patients feel like their time isn't being wasted while they're in the waiting room?

How might we use data to help a corporate recruiter make decisions about candidates and roles, faster and with higher confidence?

Design a better way for a business traveler to get from curb to gate at a hub airport much more quickly, possibly by leveraging biometric data.

How might we provide personalized client support from a virtual command center while also improving response time by at least 10 percent?

How might a data analyst better understand and exploit data that currently exists within her database?

Design a better way for a police officer to access the digital tools he needs to get his job done, safely and effectively.

Here are the questions you should ask yourself when crafting a prompt for a workshop:

- Is there a strong user empathy component? Are we making a profound positive impact for a specific user?
- What specific capability will we be giving that user? What specific pain will we be alleviating?
- Does the design prompt allow for many potential solutions? Can some of them be achieved in a reasonable timeframe and budget?
- Will we have the appropriate domain expertise present to craft solutions in this workshop?

Below are some example prompts we've seen and advice on how to improve them.

BAD: *"Allow the client's executive team to better understand how GBS will benefit his organization and empower him to communicate that benefit to the rest of his organization."*

This is a basically "help us close this deal" dressed up as a user experience prompt. Yes, the buyer is going through an experience as he/she considers IBM, but the solution is already defined. Even if we wanted to improve the way we deliver our service, we'd need to focus on the end user of the service, not the buyer.

GOOD: *"Reimagine the client center visit, so the client's executives leave having heard a single cohesive story that is memorable and easily communicated to the rest of their team."*

This is much better. It's clearly actionable and will lead to profound improvement that can be leveraged for all future delivery center visits.

BAD: *"Leverage automation in F&A to achieve cost savings."*

This one is problematic on two levels. First, there's no user. Second, it already presumes a solution: automation. Presumably there is some task within F&A that is particularly painful for a user group. Within that task, there may be sub-tasks that are particularly onerous. We need to start there. What are the weaknesses of our current solutions? Automation opportunities will surface during the workshop if the appropriate technological and domain subject matter experts are present and participating. There are also likely to be other solutions that arise that don't involve automation. Trying to bake a specific solution like this into the prompt is not appropriate.

BAD: *"Create a dashboard to give insights to CFOs."*

Here we have a clear user, with a very vague solution already in mind. What kind of insights does this specific CFO need? Only by focusing on a concrete user can we get to ideas to improve his/her experience. What is the CFO trying to accomplish? Prompts like these are more actionable:

"Help a CFO support acquisition decisions with better information around the cash flow impact of a potential acquisition."

"Help a CFO meet regulatory requirements by getting more accurate financial data more quickly."

BAD: *"Use cognitive computing to automate order-to-cash processing."*

Again, you already have a solution in mind. But even if we set that aside and give it a shot, there are questions. Is this application of Watson technology actually feasible? Unless Watson technical experts and domain SME's are attending the workshop, using 'Watson' or 'cognitive' in your workshop prompt is almost certainly a bad idea.

❻ Post-workshop success

How do I capture and share everything we did in the workshop?

Within a week of your workshop's conclusion, you should plan to hold a Workshop Playback. We'll provide a template that allows you to capture the details of your workshop as a recap for the participants and an executive summary for other key stakeholders. You should review the template before the workshop, so you'll be aware of the information you'll want to capture. Ideally, you'll appoint one person in each breakout group to be responsible for documenting the group's artifacts throughout the workshop. Download the Workshop Playback Template in .key or .ppt.

How do I bring workshop outcomes to life?

In most cases, you will leave your workshop with several work streams defined for moving forward. It is imperative that your team appoint a dedicated project manager who is accountable for the execution of all new initiatives resulting from the workshop. This person should be responsible for securing resources, creating (or integrating) project plans that include Playbacks at key milestones, and scheduling and leading regular cadence calls. Ideally this person should be appointed before the workshop so he/she can attend the event.

Appendix A: sample agendas

For a detailed guide to each exercise, download the Field Guide.

ONE-DAY WORKSHOP

- Introduction to Enterprise Design Thinking
- Project rundowns
- Empathy maps
- As-Is process maps
- Big ideas
- Prioritization grid
- To-Be process maps
- To-Dos

TWO-DAY WORKSHOP

Day 1

- Introduction to Enterprise Design Thinking
- Stakeholder maps
- Empathy maps
- As-Is process map
- Big ideas
- Prioritization grid

Day 2

- To-Be process maps
- Assumptions testing
- Hills
- Introduction to prototyping
- Playbacks
- Experience mapping
- To-Dos

FOUR-DAY WORKSHOP

Day 1

- Hopes and fears
- Introduction to Enterprise Design Thinking
- Stakeholder maps
- Empathy maps
- As-Is process map

Day 2

- Big ideas
- Prioritization grid
- Storyboarding
- To-Be process maps
- Assumptions testing
- Hills

Day 3

- Hills refinement
- Paper prototyping

Day 4

- Playbacks
- To-Dos

Appendix B: required supplies

Post-It notes (3x3)
1.5 pads per person per day. Choose a variety of colors.

- Bond links: 12-pack Assorted | Marseille | Rio Collection
- External links: 12-pack Cape Town

Post-It self-stick easel pad (25x30)
1 pad per team. Flip charts with large paper are okay, but require you to also purchase Blue-Tack.

- Bond links: 2-pack of pads | 6-pack of pads | 8-pack of pads
- External links: 2-pack of pads

Blu-Tack/Adhesive Putty
1 package per team. Order if you are using paper that is not self-adhesive.

- Bond link: 1-pack
- External link: 1-pack

Permanent black markers
1 marker per person. Any black *fine tip* marker will do.
(Sharpies, Edding 3000, another brand name, etc)

- Bond link: 12-pack
- External link: 12-pack

Colored markers
1 pack per 20 people.

- Bond link: 4-pack
- External link: 4-pack

Labeling dots
1 package (860 dots/pack).

- Bond link: 1-pack
- External Link: 1-pack

Name tags
1 per person — any kind.

Tape
1 roll per team — any kind.

Scissors
1 pair per team — any kind.

Appendix C: Enterprise Design Thinking resources

CLIENT RESOURCES

Enterprise Design Thinking Website
Public-facing site that includes more information on “The Loop,” “The Keys,” and “The Principles.”

Enterprise Design Thinking Field Guide
Guide to the most common Enterprise Design Thinking exercises.

Enterprise Design Thinking Client Video
A welcome from Phil Gilbert and a preview of the day’s activities.

INTERNAL RESOURCES

Enterprise Design Thinking for GBS Connections Community
Hub for information and tips related to Enterprise Design Thinking within GBS.

IBM Design Connections Community
Central source for information and resources related to Enterprise Design Thinking.

Enterprise Design Thinking University